

Public First Action is a 501(c)(4) nonprofit organization focused on United States public policy related to artificial intelligence. Public First Action is a bipartisan group that advocates for AI transparency, safeguards, and export controls on advanced AI chips. The organization is aligned with the political action committees Jobs and Democracy, Defending Our Values and Public First.

Public First Action Claims to be bipartisan but its first major spending for the 2026 cycle is to support a Republican (<https://www.politico.com/newsletters/playbook/2026/08/20/jennings-hits-the-harp-notes-01043233>)

History

Public First Action was formed in 2025 by former Congressmen Brad Carson, a Democrat, and Chris Stewart, a Republican, to advocate for federal, state, and local regulations related to AI. The group's formation followed the founding of a super PAC network, Leading the Future, which advocates for deregulation of the AI industry and faster development of the new technology. Public First Action supports measures that would increase transparency at frontier AI companies and impose export controls on advanced AI chips, in addition to opposing the preemption of state-level AI laws.

In February 2026, the 501(c)(4) organization Public First Action received \$20 million from the AI company Anthropic. The company later clarified that the donation could not be used for election ads.

That same month, the group announced plans to support 30 to 50 Democrats and Republicans in state and federal races, with Public First Action and aligned super PACs launching advertisements in Nebraska, Tennessee, and other states. In one ad, Senator Marsha Blackburn was touted for her work on child online safety.

As of 2026, the group plans to raise between \$50 and \$75 million for public oversight of AI and

related reforms.

Organization

Leadership and funding

Public First Action is led by Carson and Stewart. The group has raised nearly \$50 million in funding with a goal of raising \$75 million during the 2026 midterms. Anthropic has contributed \$20 million to the group.

Structure

Public First Action is aligned with three political action committees: "Jobs and Democracy", which supports Democratic candidates; "Defending Our Values", which supports Republican candidates; and "Public First", which supports both Republicans and Democrats.

See also

Regulation of artificial intelligence in the United States

== References ==